OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP | LEAN SIX SIGMA | KAIZEN | MANUFACTURING ANALYTICS

Standardizing Custom HVAC Fabrication to Create Capacity and Lead-Time Visibility

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ROLE SCOPE	PROJECT SCOPE	DURATION	METHODS & SYSTEMS
Oversight of two production floors and their operating leaders	Custom ductwork operation located on one production floor	3-4 week investigation; phased rollout and stabilization over several months	Lean, Six Sigma, Kaizen, work measurement, Excel, Ofimática

Case snapshot

Sales could not consistently provide defensible delivery dates for custom ductwork because production variability was not translated into engineered timing standards

Tenure and leadership context

I worked one level below the Director of Operations for approximately 18 months. This initiative ran alongside other Lean, Kaizen, logistics

Leadership Context and Project Governance

My operating organization

As Production Manager, I oversaw daily execution and continuous improvement across two production floors:

- Raw-material receiving, inspection, and disposition
- CNC and punch-press cutting, plus line-specific cutting
- Assembly lines organized by product family
- Multiple painting booths and spray operations
- Production-side packing and coordination with central Logistics
- Two floor industrial engineers and one demand planning engineer
- Functional leaders and multiple assembly-line leaders

I also determined when production services or labor should be subcontracted.

Ductwork project team

My role: operational owner and project lead. I performed most of the investigation, analysis, process design, meeting coordination, pilot planning, and implementation support.

Technology partner: the IT Director. The programming team implemented the approved changes in Ofimática; I defined and coordinated the operational requirements.

Operational contributors: demand planning, floor industrial engineers, production supervisors, line leader, operators, Sales, Logistics, and the Director of Operations when validation or decisions were required.

> **Leadership distinction:** I led and designed the operational solution; the IT team built the corresponding system changes.

Retrospective Project-Management Alignment

experience; selected visuals and translated artifacts were unsupported financial claims are excluded.

Initiating

Defined the delivery-estimation problem, project scope, sponsor, stakeholders, and operational stakes.

Executing

Conducted studies, created standards, developed SOPs and videos, trained teams, and

Closing

Transferred ownership into routine planning, documented the process, and established ongoing

1. Business Challenge

Custom ductwork varied by configuration, dimensional range, material and construction requirements, fabrication route, and complexity. Production did not have a consistent way to

2. Gemba Investigation

Using Genchi Genbutsu - "Go and See" - I began by studying the actual work. During the first week, I spent approximately five hours per day on the shop floor; the concentrated

3. Measurement and Root-Cause Analysis

Standard Work Measurement Analysis

Time-and-motion methodology

Representative configurations were decomposed into discrete operations and supporting activities. The production supervisors and I collected repeated stopwatch

4. Solution and Implementation

I converted product variability into a structured planning model. The historical system contained more than four categories and used a combination of:

- **Configuration and component type:** L- and C-type configurations and fitting

5. Operational Impact

Sales moved from "call the line leader" to a live capacity view supported by standardized planning information.